Invent an Insect

ENTOMOLOGY

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1) My insect's habitat: The Blue Buffterfly lives in rainforest jungle. It prefers areas with thick canopies where its glow can be seen clearly .

2) My insect's food source: Just like a regular butterfly, it feeds on floral nectar and sometimes drinks mineral-rich water from damp soil.

3) How it finds and eats its food: It uses its long antennae to "smell" sweet flowers from far away. It eats using a proboscis, which is a long, straw-like tube that uncurls to reach deep into the center of rainforest flowers to suck up nectar.

4) How my insect moves: It flies through the air, but much more slowly than a normal butterfly. It moves with a graceful, floating motion. Most uniquely, they move in coordinated teams, performing swirling patterns in the air that look like a drone light show.

5) What eats my insect: Because it is so bright, it is easy for predators like large jungle frogs, lizards, and night birds to see it.

6) How my insect escapes predators: It doesn't use speed to escape. Instead, it uses its intense glow. When a predator gets too close, the Blue Buffterfly can pulse its light very brightly to momentarily dazzle or "blind" the predator, giving the insect time to float away into the thick leaves.

CALIFORNIA ACADEMY OF SCIENCES

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Draw your insect below. Be sure to label its body parts.

Name of my insect: The Blue Buffterfly

Habitat: They are often found flying in teams, performing beautiful aerial shows that look like a synchronized drone light show.

Special adaptations: They have the "skill" to work together to create light patterns, showing they are highly intelligent.